

# Week 9 & 10

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## 1. Convex Set

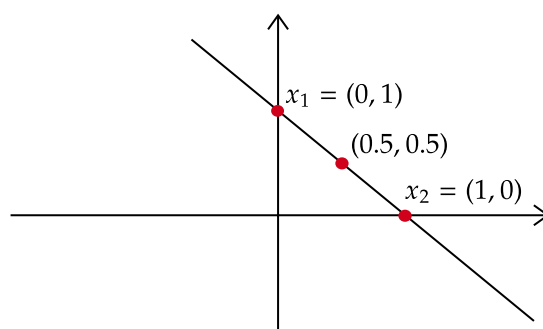
A set  $S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$  is a convex set, if, for all  $x_1, x_2 \in S$ , and for all  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$

$$(\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2 \in S$$

**NOTE** : From here, assume  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$ , wherever used.

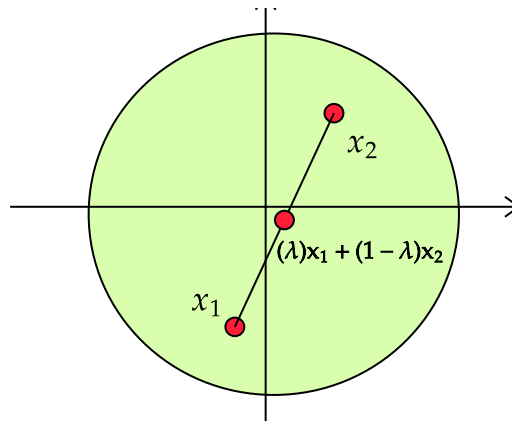
### Example

$$S = \{(x, y) \mid x + y = 1\}$$



## Example

$$S = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^2 \mid \|x\|^2 \leq 9\}$$



## PROOF

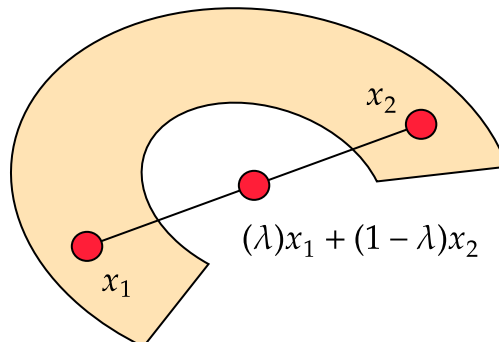
- **Triangular Inequality** :  $\|u + v\| \leq \|u\| + \|v\|$ , where  $u, v \in \mathbb{R}^d$
- $\|c \times u\| = |c| \times \|u\|$ , where  $c \in \mathbb{R}$  and  $u \in \mathbb{R}^d$

$$\begin{aligned}\|(\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2\| &\leq \|(\lambda)x_1\| + \|(1 - \lambda)x_2\| \\ &\leq (|\lambda|)\|x_1\| + (|1 - \lambda|)\|x_2\| \\ &\leq (\lambda)3 + (1 - \lambda)3 \\ &\leq 3 \\ \|(\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2\|^2 &\leq 9\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,  $S$  is a convex set.

## Non-Example

The following is not a convex set



### Example

Show that  $S = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^d \mid w^T x = b\}$  is a convex set.

- Let  $x_1, x_2 \in S$ , i.e.,  $w^T x_1 = b$  and  $w^T x_2 = b$
- Let  $v = (\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2$ ,  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$

$$\begin{aligned}w^T v &= w^T [(\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2] \\&= (\lambda)w^T x_1 + (1 - \lambda)w^T x_2 \\&= (\lambda)b + (1 - \lambda)b \\&= b\end{aligned}$$

$v \in S$ . Therefore,  $S$  is a convex set.

### Example

Show that  $S = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^d \mid w^T x \leq b\}$  is a convex set.

- Let  $x_1, x_2 \in S$ , i.e.,  $w^T x_1 < b$  and  $w^T x_2 < b$
- Let  $v = (\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2$ ,  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$

Notice,

- $(\lambda)w^T x_1 \leq (\lambda)b$
- $(1 - \lambda)w^T x_2 \leq (1 - \lambda)b$

$$\begin{aligned}w^T v &= w^T [(\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2] \\&= (\lambda)w^T x_1 + (1 - \lambda)w^T x_2 \\&\leq (\lambda)b + (1 - \lambda)b \\&\leq b\end{aligned}$$

$v \in S$ . Therefore,  $S$  is a convex set.

### Example

Show that  $S = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^d \mid (A_{n \times d})x = b\}$  is a convex set.

- Let  $x_1, x_2 \in S$ , i.e.,  $(A_{n \times d})x_1 = b$  and  $(A_{n \times d})x_2 = b$
- Let  $v = (\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2$ ,  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$

$$\begin{aligned}
(A_{n \times d})v &= (A_{n \times d})[(\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2] \\
&= (\lambda)(A_{n \times d})x_1 + (1 - \lambda)(A_{n \times d})x_2 \\
&= (\lambda)b + (1 - \lambda)b \\
&= b
\end{aligned}$$

$v \in S$ . Therefore,  $S$  is a convex set.

## A Property Of Convex Set

Intersection of convex sets is convex.

### PROOF

- Let  $S_1$  and  $S_2$  be convex sets.
- $x_1, x_2 \in S_1$
- $x_1, x_2 \in S_2$
- Let  $x_1, x_2 \in S_1 \cap S_2$

Since  $S_1$  is a convex set, we can say that  $(\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2 \in S_1, \lambda \in [0, 1]$

Since  $S_2$  is a convex set, we can say that  $(\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2 \in S_2, \lambda \in [0, 1]$

Therefore,  $(\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2 \in S_1 \cap S_2$ .

$S_1 \cap S_2$  is a convex set

## EXAMPLE

Show that  $S = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^d \mid A_{n \times d}x = b\}$  is a convex set.

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} - & a_1 & - \\ - & a_2 & - \\ & \vdots & \\ - & a_n & - \end{bmatrix}, \quad x = \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ \vdots \\ x_d \end{bmatrix}, \quad b = \begin{bmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \\ \vdots \\ b_n \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
S &= \{x \in \mathbb{R}^d \mid A_{n \times d}x = b\} \\
&= \{x \in \mathbb{R}^d \mid a_1^T x = b_1, \dots, a_n^T x = b_n\} \\
&= \{x \in \mathbb{R}^d \mid a_1^T x = b_1\} \cap \dots \cap \{x \in \mathbb{R}^d \mid a_n^T x = b_n\}
\end{aligned}$$

$\{x \in \mathbb{R}^d | a_i^T x = b_i\}$  is a convex set.  $S$  is an intersection of convex sets and therefore,  $S$  is a convex set.

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## 2. Convex Combination

Let  $S = \{x_1, \dots, x_n\} \in \mathbb{R}^d$ .

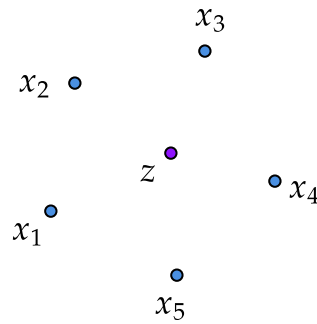
$z \in \mathbb{R}^d$  is said to be a **convex combination** of  $x_1, \dots, x_n$  if

$$z = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i x_i$$

where  $\alpha_i \geq 0$ ,  $\forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$  and

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i = 1$$

**Example :** Let  $S = \{x_1, \dots, x_5\}$ .



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## 3. Convex Hull

Let  $S = \{x_1, \dots, x_n\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ . Then

$$\text{Convex - Hull}(S) = \left\{ z \in \mathbb{R}^d \left| z = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i x_i, \alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n \geq 0, \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i = 1 \right. \right\}$$

In simple words, it is the set of all possible **convex combinations** of the elements in set  $S$ .

**Convex - Hull**( $S$ ) is a convex set. Proof is given below.

- Let  $z_1, z_2 \in \text{Convex-Hull}(S)$
- $z_1 = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_{(1,i)} x_i$  where,  $\alpha_{(1,i)} > 0, \forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$  and  $\sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_{1,i} = 1$
- $z_2 = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_{(2,i)} x_i$  where,  $\alpha_{(2,i)} > 0, \forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$  and  $\sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_{2,i} = 1$
- Let  $z'$  be  $(\lambda)z_1 + (1 - \lambda)z_2, \lambda \in [0, 1]$

$$\begin{aligned}
 z' &= (\lambda)z_1 + (1 - \lambda)z_2 \\
 &= (\lambda) \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_{(1,i)} x_i + (1 - \lambda) \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_{(2,i)} x_i \\
 &= \sum_{i=1}^n (\lambda \alpha_{(1,i)}) x_i + \sum_{i=1}^n ((1 - \lambda) \alpha_{(2,i)}) x_i \\
 &= \sum_{i=1}^n \left[ (\lambda \alpha_{1,i}) + ((1 - \lambda) \alpha_{2,i}) \right] x_i
 \end{aligned}$$

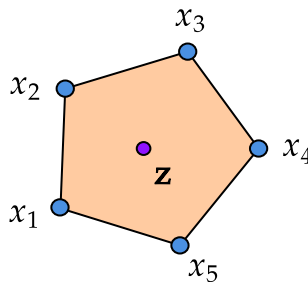
Notice,  $(\lambda \alpha_{(1,i)}) + ((1 - \lambda) \alpha_{(2,i)}) \geq 0 \forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$ .

$$\begin{aligned}
 \sum_{i=1}^n \left[ (\lambda \alpha_{(1,i)}) + ((1 - \lambda) \alpha_{(2,i)}) \right] &= \lambda \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_{(1,i)} + (1 - \lambda) \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_{(2,i)} \\
 &= \lambda(1) + (1 - \lambda)(1) \\
 &= 1
 \end{aligned}$$

$z'$  is a convex combination of the elements in  $S$ . Therefore, **Convex-Hull**( $S$ ) is a convex set.

## Example

Let  $S = \{x_1, \dots, x_5\}$



In the above picture,  $z$  is a convex combination of  $x_1, \dots, x_5$  and the brown shaded region is the convex hull of  $S$ .

## ALTERNATE DEFINITION

**Convex – Hull**( $\{x_1, \dots, x_n\}$ ) is the intersection of all the **convex** sets containing  $\{x_1, \dots, x_n\}$ .

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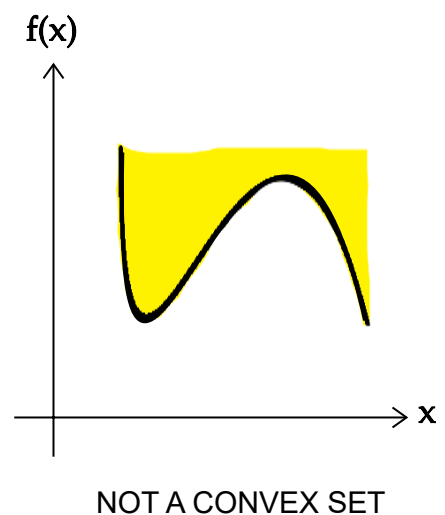
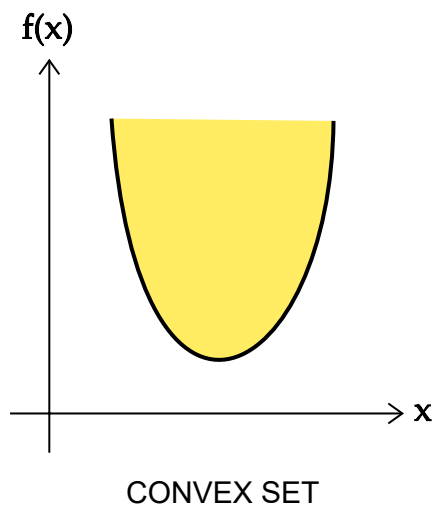
## 4. Convex Function

### DEFINITION 1

Let  $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$  be a convex set. A function  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is a convex function if **epi**( $f$ ) is a convex set.

$$\text{epi}(f) = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} x \\ z \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^{d+1} \mid z \geq f(x) \right\}$$

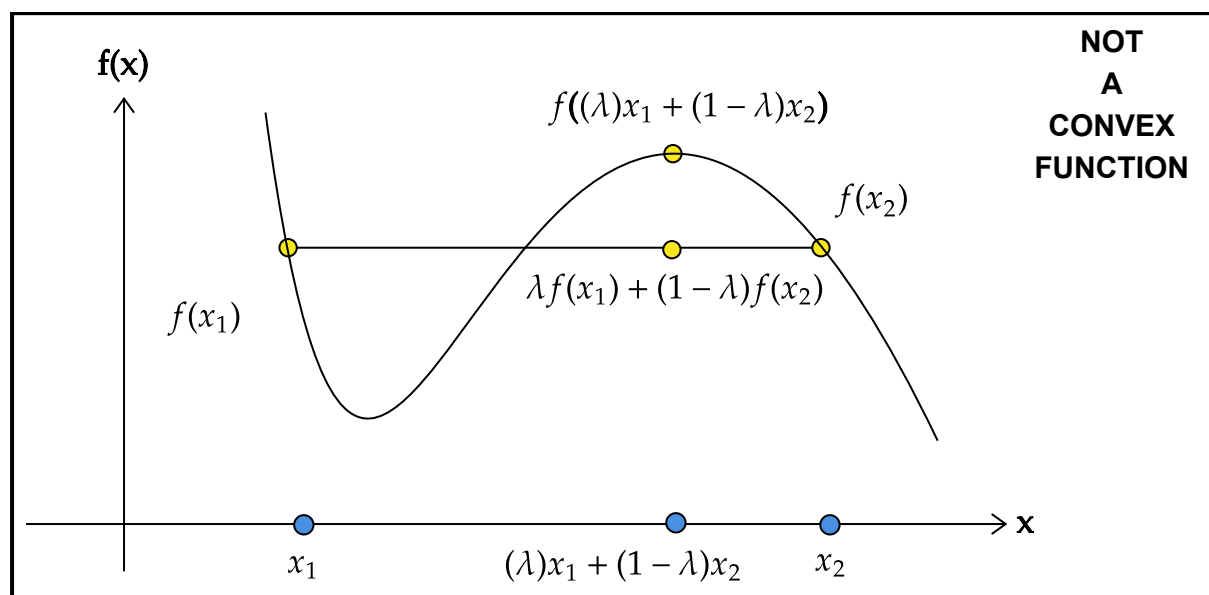
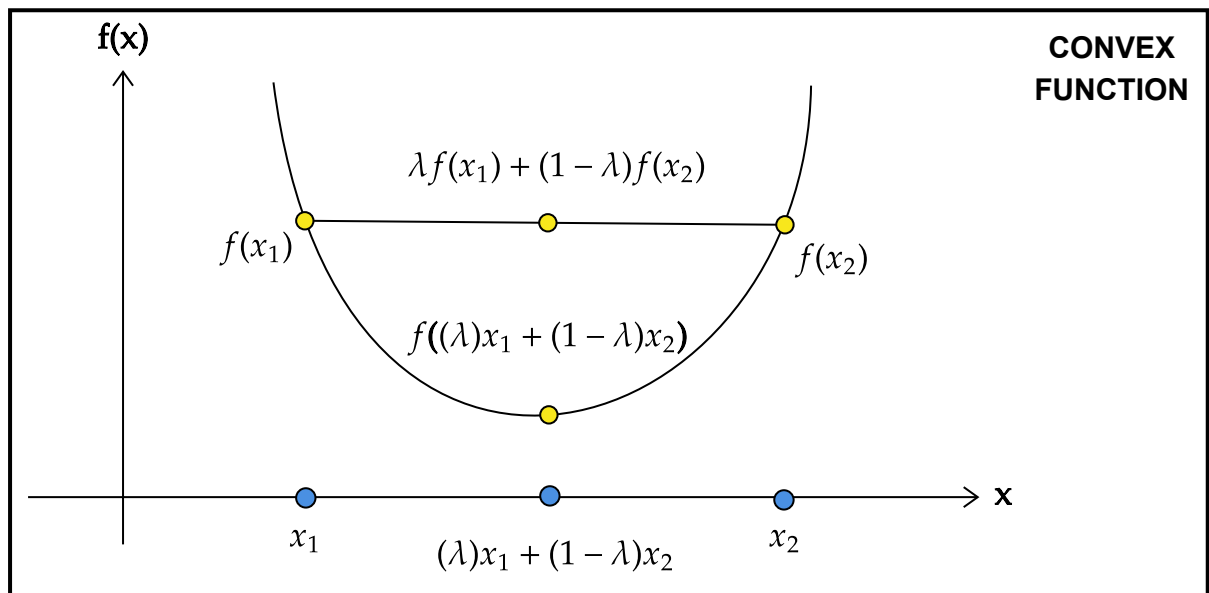
Here,  $\begin{bmatrix} x \\ z \end{bmatrix} = [x_1 \ x_2 \ \dots \ x_d \ z]^T$ .



### DEFINITION 2

Let  $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$  be a convex set. A function  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is a convex function if and only if  $\forall x_1, x_2 \in \mathbb{R}^d$  and for all  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$ ,

$$f((\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2) \leq \lambda f(x_1) + (1 - \lambda)f(x_2)$$



### DEFINITION 3

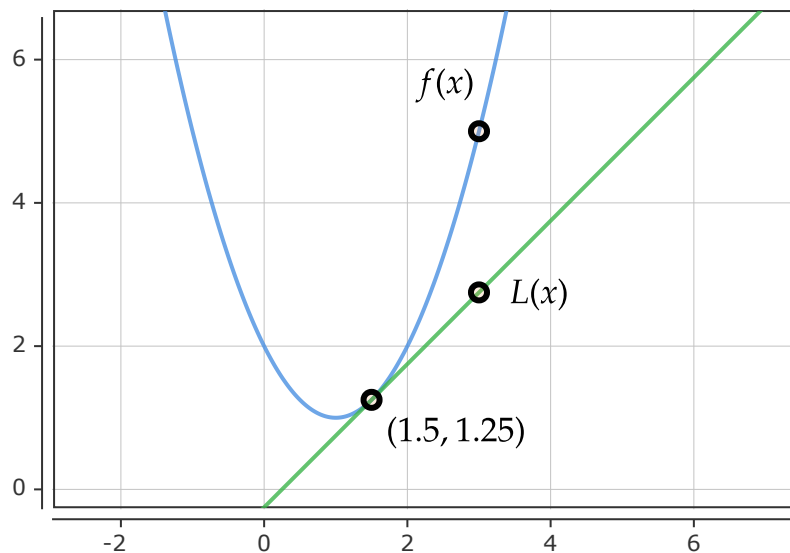
Let  $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$  be a convex set. A **differentiable** function  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is a convex function if and only if

$$f(x) \geq f(a) + (x - a)^T \nabla f(a)$$

for all  $a \in D$

In simple terms, this means that the value of the function at any point is always greater than or equal to its linear approximation at that point.





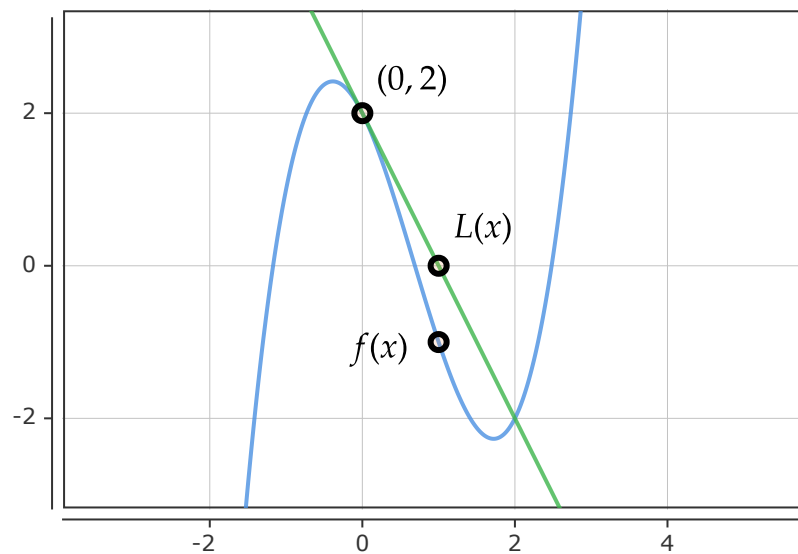
**CONVEX  
FUNCTION**

$$\text{— } f(x) = x^2 - 2x + 2$$

$$\text{— } L(x) = 1.25 + (x - 1.5)(1)$$

$$f(1.5) = 1.25$$

$$\nabla f(1.5) = 1$$



**NOT  
A  
CONVEX  
FUNCTION**

$$\text{— } f(x) = x^3 - 2x^2 - 2x + 2$$

$$\text{— } L(x) = 2 + (x - 0)(-2)$$

$$f(0) = 2$$

$$\nabla f(0) = -2$$

## DEFINITION 4

Let  $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$  be a convex set. Let a function  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be twice differentiable.  $\mathbf{H}$  is a  $d \times d$  matrix such that, for all  $i, j \in \{1, 2, \dots, d\}$

$$H_{ij} = \frac{\delta^2 f}{\delta x_i \delta x_j}$$

$f$  is a convex function if and only if  $H_f(v)$  is a **positive semi-definite** matrix for all  $v \in D$ .

If  $f$  is a function of one variable, *i. e.*, if  $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ , then  $f$  is convex if

$$f''(x) \geq 0, \quad \forall x \in D$$

## 5. Properties of Convex Functions

## PROPERTY 1

The domain of a convex function is always a convex set.

### PROOF

Let  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a convex function. Let us assume that  $D$  is not a convex set.

Since  $D$  is not a convex function, for some  $x, y \in D$ , where  $x \neq y$ , there exists a  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$  such that

$$\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y \notin D$$

Since  $f$  is a convex function, we can say:

$$f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) \leq \lambda f(x) + (1 - \lambda)f(y)$$

Since  $f$  is convex, the above inequality must hold true. But,  $\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y$  is not in  $D$ .  $f$  cannot be defined at  $\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y$ . There is a contradiction. Our assumption is incorrect. Therefore,  $f$  is not a convex function.

## PROPERTY 2

Let  $D \in \mathbb{R}^d$  be a convex set. If  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is a convex function, then all local minima of  $f$  are also global minima.

### PROOF

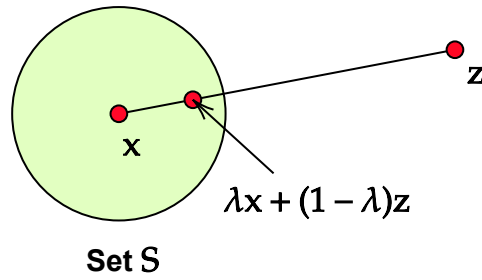
Assume the following

- $x$  is a local minimum of  $f$  but **not** a global minimum of  $f$
- $z$  is a global minimum of  $f$
- $f(z) < f(x)$

Since  $x$  is a local minimum, we can say that there exist a  $\delta > 0$  such that  $f(x) \leq f(v)$  for all  $v$  in the following set.

$$S = \left\{ v \mid \|x - v\| \leq \delta \right\}$$

The above set is represented by the following circle. Let us take a small step from  $x$  towards  $z$  such that we stay within set  $S$ . It is given by  $\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)z$ ,  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$ .



From our assumption,  $f(z) < f(x)$ . Therefore,

$$\lambda f(x) + (1 - \lambda)f(z) < \lambda f(x) + (1 - \lambda)f(x)$$

$\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)z \in S$ . Therefore,

$$f(x) \leq f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)z)$$

$$f(x) \leq \lambda f(x) + (1 - \lambda)f(z)$$

$$f(x) < \lambda f(x) + (1 - \lambda)f(x)$$

$$f(x) < f(x)$$

$f(x) < f(x)$  is a contradiction. Therefore, our assumption that  $f(z) < f(x)$  is incorrect. Therefore,  $x$  is also a global minimum of  $f$ .

### PROPERTY 3

Let  $D \in \mathbb{R}^d$  be a convex set and let  $f: D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a differentiable convex function.  $z \in D$  is a global minimum if and only if  $\nabla f(z) = 0$ .

### PROOF

To prove that the above property is true, we must show that the following are true.

- If  $z$  is a global minimum, then  $\nabla f(z) = 0$
- If  $\nabla f(z) = 0$ , then  $f$  is a global minimum

**(A)** If  $z$  is a global minimum, then  $\nabla f(z) = 0$

Let us assume that  $z$  is a global minimum of  $f$  and  $\nabla f(z) \neq 0$ . Since  $\nabla f(z) \neq 0$ ,  $-\nabla f(z)$  is the direction of steepest descent at  $z$ .

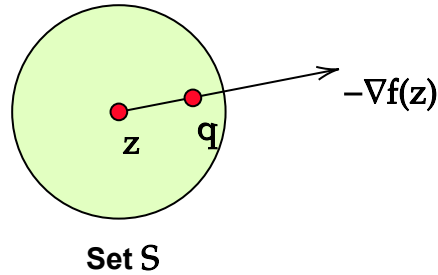
Since  $z$  is a global minimum,  $z$  is also a local minimum. There exists a  $\delta > 0$  such that  $f(z) \leq f(y)$  for all  $y \in S$ , where

$$S = \left\{ y \mid \|z - y\| \leq \delta \right\}$$

From  $z$ , let us move to  $q$ , where

$$q = z - \beta \frac{\nabla f(z)}{\|\nabla f(z)\|}$$

and  $0 < \beta < \delta$ .



Since  $-\nabla f(z)$  is the direction of steepest descent,

$$f(q) < f(z)$$

Since  $0 < \beta < \delta$ ,  $q \in S$ . Since  $q \in S$ ,  $f(q) \geq f(z)$ .

We have a contradiction. Our assumption is incorrect. Therefore,  $\nabla f(z) = 0$

**(B)** If  $\nabla f(z) = 0$ , then  $f$  is a global minimum

From the definition of convex function, for all  $y \in D$ ,

$$f(y) \geq f(z) + \nabla f(z)^T (y - z)$$

Since  $\nabla f(z) = 0$ , we get

$$f(y) \geq f(z)$$

Therefore,  $z$  is a global minimum.

## PROPERTY 4

The sum of two convex functions is a convex function.

### PROOF

Let  $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$  be a convex set and let  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  and  $g : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be convex functions. We have to show that  $h : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is a convex function, where

$$h(x) = f(x) + g(x), \quad \forall x \in D$$

Let  $u, v \in \mathbb{R}^d$  and let  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$

$$\begin{aligned}h(\lambda u + (1 - \lambda)v) &= f(\lambda u + (1 - \lambda)v) + g(\lambda u + (1 - \lambda)v) \\&\leq \lambda f(u) + (1 - \lambda)f(v) + \lambda g(u) + (1 - \lambda)g(v) \\&\leq \lambda[f(u) + g(u)] + (1 - \lambda)[f(v) + g(v)] \\&\leq \lambda h(u) + (1 - \lambda)h(v)\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,  $h(x)$  is a convex function.

## PROPERTY 5

Let  $D$  be a convex set. Let  $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a non-decreasing convex function and let  $g : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a convex function. Then,  $h$  is a convex function, where

$$h(x) = f(g(x)), \quad \forall x \in D$$

### PROOF

Since  $f$  is a non decreasing function, we can say that for all  $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$ , if  $x \leq y$ , then

$$f(x) \leq f(y)$$

Let  $u, v \in D$  and let  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$

$$g(\lambda u + (1 - \lambda)v) \leq \lambda g(u) + (1 - \lambda)g(v)$$

Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned}h(\lambda u + (1 - \lambda)v) &= f(g(\lambda u + (1 - \lambda)v)) \\&\leq f(\lambda g(u) + (1 - \lambda)g(v)) \\&\leq \lambda f(g(u)) + (1 - \lambda)f(g(v)) \\&\leq \lambda h(u) + (1 - \lambda)h(v)\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,  $h$  is a convex function

## PROPERTY 6

Let  $D$  be a convex set. Let  $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a convex function and let  $g : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a linear function. Then,  $h$  is a convex function, where

$$h(x) = f(g(x)), \quad \forall x \in D$$

## PROOF

Since  $g$  is a linear function, the following is true for all  $u, v \in D$  and for all  $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{R}$

$$g(\alpha u + \beta v) = \alpha g(u) + \beta g(v)$$

Let  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$

$$\begin{aligned} h(\lambda u + (1 - \lambda)v) &= f(g(\lambda u + (1 - \lambda)v)) \\ &= f(\lambda g(u) + (1 - \lambda)g(v)) \\ &\leq \lambda f(g(u)) + (1 - \lambda)f(g(v)) \\ &\leq \lambda h(u) + (1 - \lambda)h(v) \end{aligned}$$

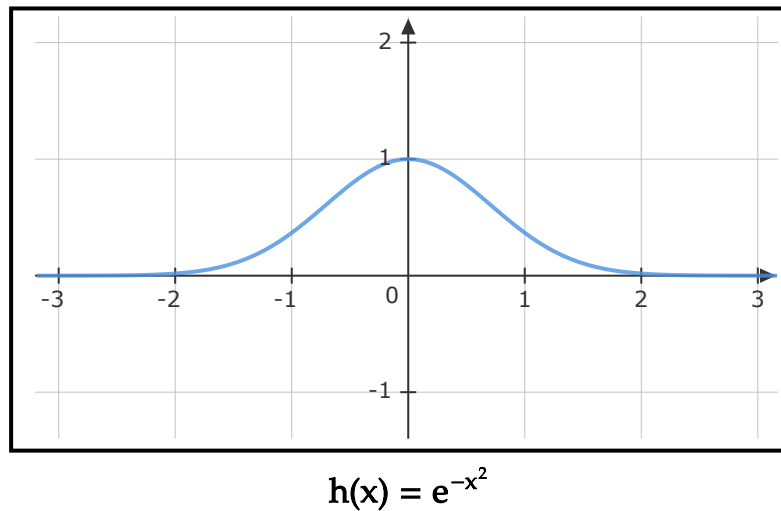
Therefore,  $h$  is a convex function

## Caveat

In general, the composition of two convex functions need not be convex. Here is an example.

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= e^{-x} \\ g(x) &= x^2 \end{aligned}$$

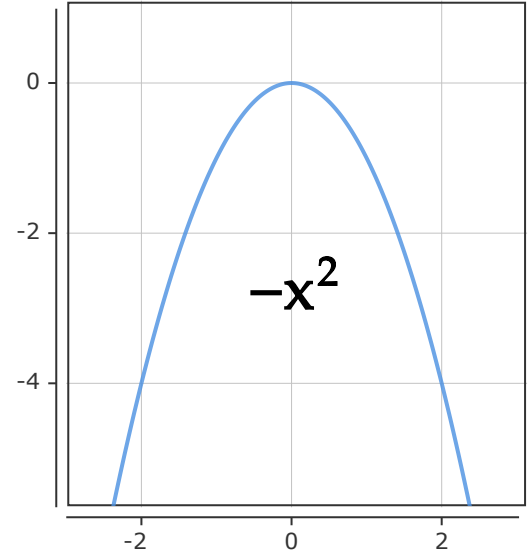
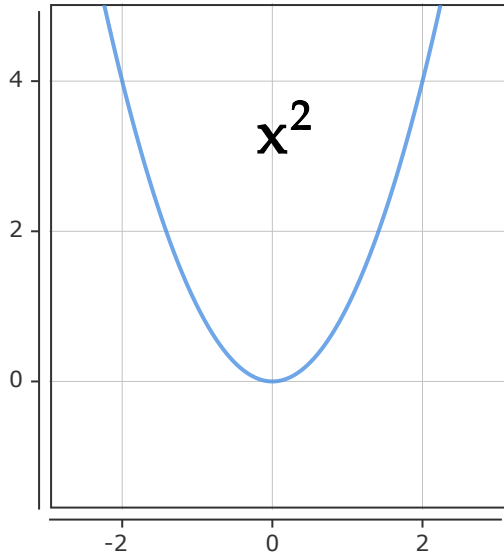
$h(x) = e^{-x^2}$  is not a convex function.



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## 6. Concave Function

A function  $f(x)$  is concave if  $-f(x)$  is convex.



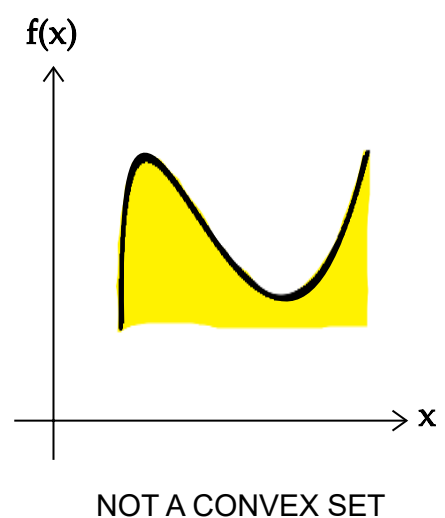
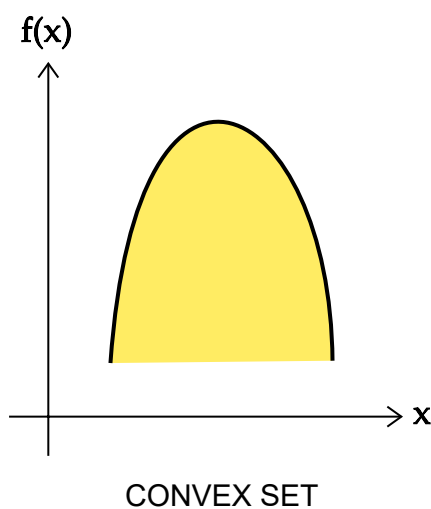
The definitions and properties of concave functions are similar to that of convex functions. Therefore, we will list them without proofs.

## DEFINITION 1

A function  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is a concave function if the hypograph of  $f$ , denoted by  $\text{hyp}(f)$  is a convex set.

$$\text{hyp}(f) = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} x \\ z \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^{d+1} \mid z \leq f(x) \right\}$$

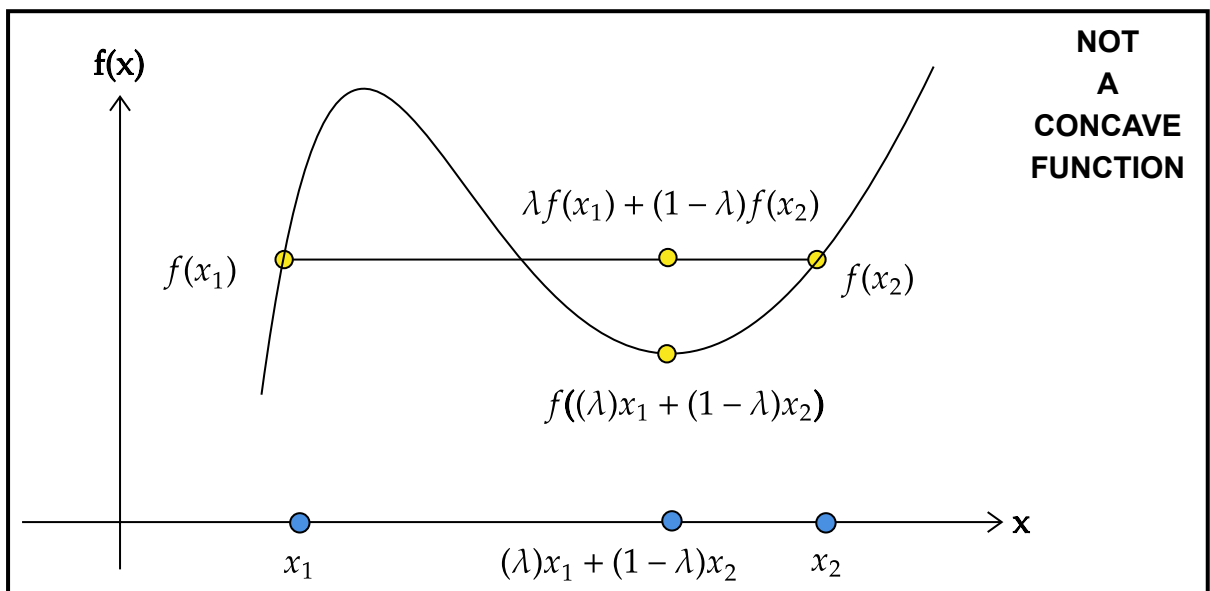
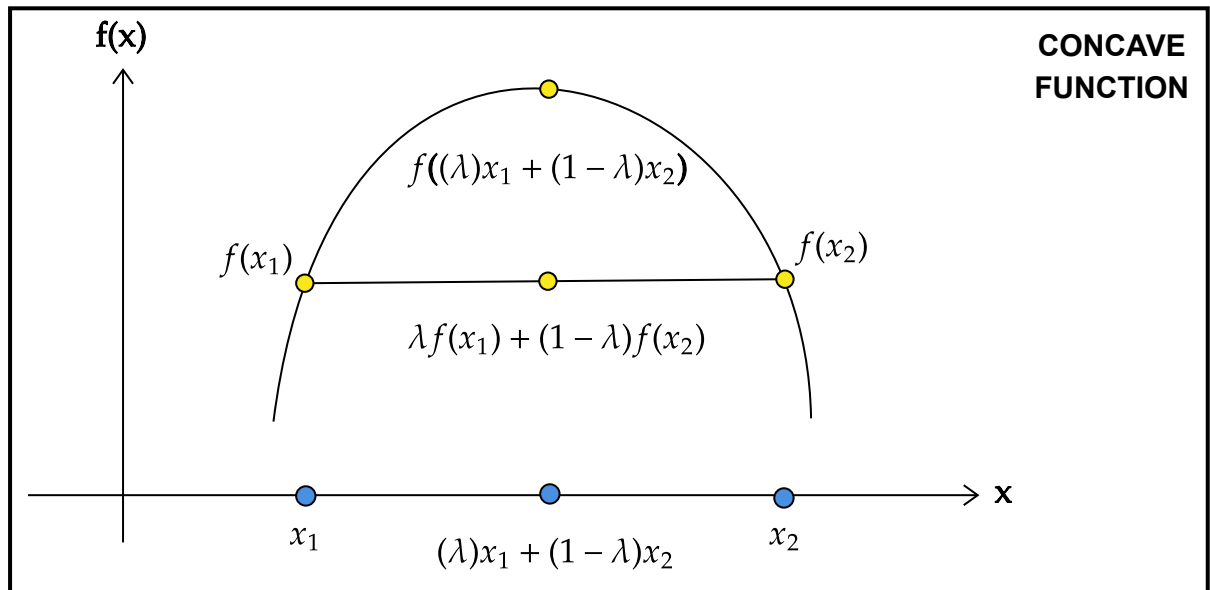
Here,  $\begin{bmatrix} x \\ z \end{bmatrix} = [x_1 \ x_2 \ \cdots \ x_d \ z]^T$ .



## DEFINITION 2

A function  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is a concave function if and only if  $\forall x_1, x_2 \in \mathbb{R}^d$  and for all  $\lambda \in [0, 1]$ ,

$$f((\lambda)x_1 + (1 - \lambda)x_2) \geq \lambda f(x_1) + (1 - \lambda)f(x_2)$$



### DEFINITION 3

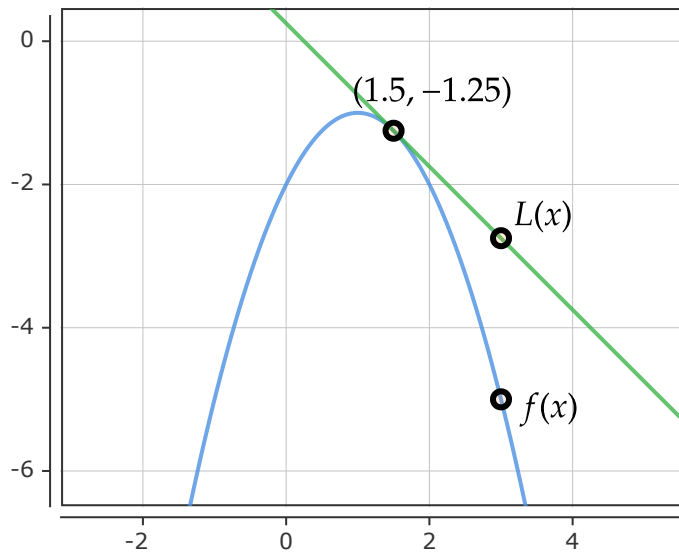
A **differentiable** function  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is a concave function if and only if

$$f(x) \leq f(a) + (x - a)^T \nabla f(a)$$

for all  $a \in D$

In simple terms, this means that the value of the function at any point is always less than or equal to its linear approximation at that point.





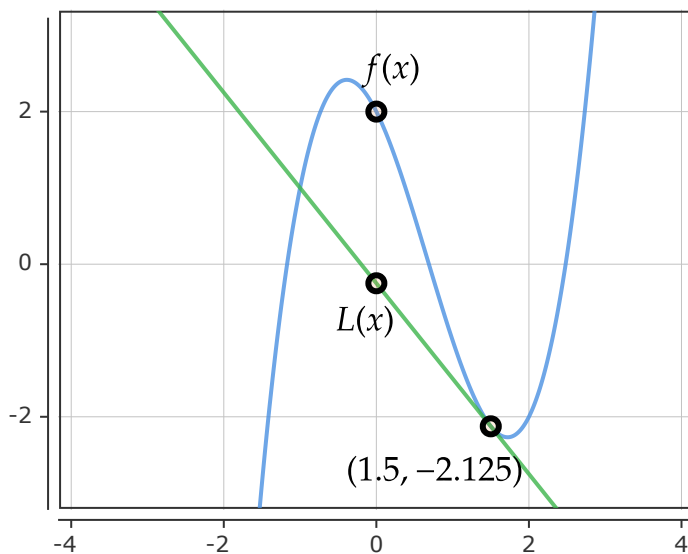
### CONCAVE FUNCTION

$$f(x) = -x^2 + 2x - 2$$

$$L(x) = -1.25 - (1)(x - 1.5)$$

$$f(1.5) = -1.25$$

$$\nabla f(1.5) = 1$$



### NOT A CONCAVE FUNCTION

$$f(x) = x^3 - 2x^2 - 2x + 2$$

$$L(x) = -2.125 - 1.25(x - 1.5)$$

$$f(1.5) = -2.125$$

$$\nabla f(1.5) = -1.25$$

## DEFINITION 4

Let a function  $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be twice differentiable.  $\mathbf{H}$  is a  $d \times d$  matrix such that for all  $i, j \in \{1, 2, \dots, d\}$

$$H_{ij} = \frac{\delta^2 f}{\delta x_i \delta x_j}$$

$f$  is a concave function if and only if  $H_f(v)$  is a **negative semi-definite** matrix for all  $v \in D$ .

If  $f$  is a function of one variable, *i. e.*, if  $D \in \mathbb{R}$ , then  $f$  is concave if

$$f''(x) \leq 0, \quad \forall x \in D$$

## PROPERTIES

- The domain of a concave function is always a convex set.
- Let  $f$  be a concave function. All the local maxima of  $f$  are also the global maxima of  $f$ .

- Let  $f$  be a differentiable concave function.  $z$  is a global maximum of  $f$  if and only if  $\nabla f(z) = 0$ .
  - The sum of two concave functions is concave.
  - Let  $D \in \mathbb{R}^d$  be a convex set. Let  $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a non-decreasing concave function and let  $g : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a concave function. Then,  $h(x) = f(g(x))$ ,  $\forall x \in D$  is a concave function.
  - Let  $D \in \mathbb{R}^d$  be a convex set. Let  $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a concave function and let  $g : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a linear function. Then,  $h(x) = f(g(x))$ ,  $\forall x \in D$  is a concave function.
  - **Caveat** : The composition of two concave function, need not be concave, Let  $f(x) = -e^x$  and let  $g(x) = x^2$ .  $f$  and  $g$  are concave. However,  $h(x) = f(g(x)) = -e^{-x^2}$  is not concave
- 

## 7. Necessary vs Sufficient vs Necessary & Sufficient Conditions (Meaning)

Through an example let us understand the meaning of **necessary condition** and **sufficient condition** and **necessary and sufficient condition**

**Statement** : A number  $n$  is divisible by 6

- **Necessary Condition** :  $n$  is divisible by 2
  - **Sufficient Condition** :  $n$  is divisible by 12
  - **Necessary & Sufficient Condition** :  $n$  is divisible by 2 and 3
- 
- A **necessary condition** is something that must be true, but by itself does not guarantee the result.
  - A **sufficient condition** is something that guarantees the result. but is not required for the statement to be always true.
  - A **necessary and sufficient condition** is something that guarantees the result and is required for the statement to be true.
- 

## 8. Constrained Optimization

### General Form

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \min_x f(x) \\
 & \text{s. t.} \\
 & p_1(x) \leq 0, \dots, p_n(x) \leq 0 \\
 & q_1(x) = 0, \dots, q_m(x) = 0
 \end{aligned}$$

- $f(x)$  is the objective function
- $p_1(x) \leq 0, \dots, p_n(x) \leq 0$  are the inequality constraints
- $q_1(x) = 0, \dots, q_m(x) = 0$  are the equality constraints

## Lagrangian Function

For the general form of constrained optimization, the following function is called the lagrangian function.

$$L(x, \alpha, \beta) = f(x) + \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i p_i(x) + \sum_{j=1}^m \beta_j q_j(x)$$

where,

$$\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_1 \\ \alpha_2 \\ \vdots \\ \alpha_n \end{pmatrix}, \beta = \begin{pmatrix} \beta_1 \\ \beta_2 \\ \vdots \\ \beta_m \end{pmatrix}$$

$\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n$  and  $\beta_1, \dots, \beta_m$  are called the lagrange multipliers.

The multipliers of inequality constraints must be non-negative. That is,  $\alpha_i \geq 0, \forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$ .

## Primal Formulation

Let us focus on

$$\begin{aligned} \min_x \quad & f(x) \\ \text{s. t.} \quad & \\ & g(x) \leq 0 \end{aligned}$$

The above formulation is referred to as the **primal formulation**.

Consider the Lagrangian function, ( $\lambda \geq 0$ )

$$L(x, \lambda) = f(x) + \lambda g(x)$$

For a fixed  $\hat{x}$  in the domain of  $f$ , let us consider the following.

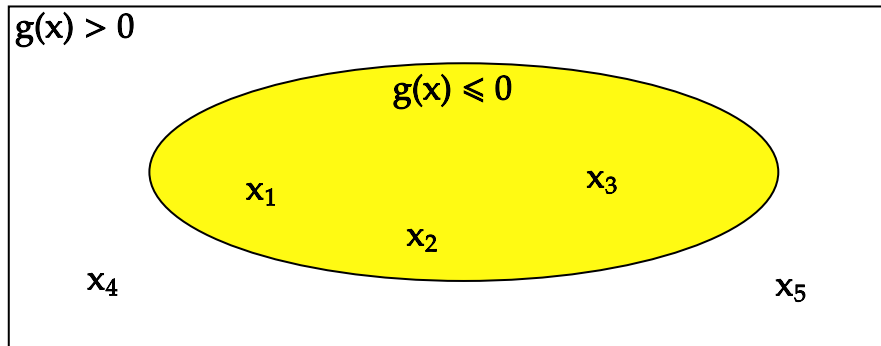
$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} f(\hat{x}) + \lambda g(\hat{x})$$

- If  $h(\hat{x}) \leq 0$ , then  $f(\hat{x}) + \lambda g(\hat{x})$  is maximum when  $\lambda = 0$ .
- If  $h(\hat{x}) > 0$ , then  $\max_{\lambda \geq 0} f(\hat{x}) + \lambda g(\hat{x}) = 0$ . As we increase  $\lambda$ ,  $\lambda g(\hat{x})$  increases. Since we are maximizing with respect to  $\lambda \geq 0$ , we can arbitrarily increase  $\lambda$ .

In the figure, given below, let the yellow region be the constraint set  $S$ .

$$S = \{x | g(x) \leq 0\}$$

Outside the yellow region, the constraint  $g(x) \leq 0$  is not met.



$x_1, x_2$  and  $x_3$  are within the constraint set and  $x_4$  and  $x_5$  are outside the constraint set. Let us fix these points and maximize the Lagrangian function with respect to  $\lambda \geq 0$

Fix  $x_1$

$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} f(x_1) + \lambda g(x_1) = f(x_1)$$

Fix  $x_2$

$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} f(x_2) + \lambda g(x_2) = f(x_2)$$

Fix  $x_3$

$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} f(x_3) + \lambda g(x_3) = f(x_3)$$

Fix  $x_4$

$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} f(x_4) + \lambda g(x_4) = \infty$$

Fix  $x_5$

$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} f(x_5) + \lambda g(x_5) = \infty$$

Suppose, the domain of  $f$  is  $\{x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5\}$ , then

$$\begin{aligned} \min_x f(x) \\ \text{s.t. } g(x) \leq 0 \end{aligned} = \min (f(x_1), f(x_2), f(x_3))$$

This is true as  $g(x) \leq 0$  is satisfied only at  $x_1, x_2$  and  $x_3$ . Similarly,

$$\min_x \max_{\lambda \geq 0} [f(x) + \lambda g(x)] = \min (f(x_1), f(x_2), f(x_3))$$

From the above illustration, it is clear that solving the constrained optimization problem

$$\begin{aligned} \min_x & f(x) \\ \text{s.t.} & \\ & g(x) \leq 0 \end{aligned}$$

is equivalent to solving

$$\min_x \max_{\lambda \geq 0} [f(x) + \lambda g(x)]$$

## Dual Formulation

We know that the following is true

$$\begin{aligned} \min_x & f(x) \\ \text{s.t.} & \\ & g(x) \leq 0 \end{aligned} \equiv \min_x \max_{\lambda \geq 0} [f(x) + \lambda g(x)]$$

The **dual formulation** for the above is given below.

$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} \min_x [f(x) + \lambda g(x)]$$

In the dual formulation, we have interchanged min and max . This leads us to two concepts.

- Weak Duality
- Strong Duality

## Weak Duality

Consider the following function.

$$J(x) = \begin{cases} f(x), & \text{if } g(x) \leq 0 \\ \infty, & \text{if } g(x) > 0 \end{cases}$$

For any fixed  $\lambda \geq 0$

- If  $g(x) \leq 0$ , then  $\lambda g(x) \leq 0$ . Therefore,

$$L(x, \lambda) = f(x) + \lambda g(x) \leq f(x)$$

- If  $g(x) > 0$ , then  $\lambda g(x) \geq 0$ . Therefore,

$$L(x, \lambda) = f(x) + \lambda g(x) \leq \infty$$

Therefore, for any fixed  $\lambda \geq 0$ , and for all  $x$  in the domain of  $f$ ,

$$L(x, \lambda) = f(x) + \lambda g(x) \leq J(x) \quad (1)$$

Let  $x^*$  be the solution for the primal formulation. That is,

$$x^* = \arg \min_x f(x), \text{ s. t., } g(x) \leq 0$$

Note that  $x^*$  satisfies  $g(x^*) \leq 0$ . Therefore,

$$x^* = \arg \min_x J(x)$$

Also,

$$\min_x J(x) = f(x^*)$$

Equation (1) is true for any fixed  $\lambda \geq 0$  for all  $x$  in the domain of  $f$ . Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} \min_x [f(x) + \lambda g(x)] &\leq \min_x J(x) \\ \min_x [f(x) + \lambda g(x)] &\leq f(x^*) \end{aligned}$$

The above inequality is true for any  $\lambda \geq 0$ . Therefore,

$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} \min_x [f(x) + \lambda g(x)] \leq f(x^*)$$

The left hand side of the inequality is the dual formulation. The right hand side is the value of  $f(x)$  at the primal optimal  $x^*$ . The dual formulation provides a **lower bound** for the **optimal** value of primal formulation. This property is called the **weak duality**.

## Strong Duality

If  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  are convex, and they satisfy some regularity conditions (for our purpose, we can ignore those), then the following is true.

$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} \min_x [f(x) + \lambda g(x)] = f(x^*)$$

This property is referred to as the **strong duality**.

When strong duality holds, we can either solve the primal problem or the dual problem.

## KKT Condition (Informal)

Let us define  $x^*$  and  $\lambda^*$  as follows,

$$x^* = \arg \min_x f(x), \text{ s. t., } g(x) \leq 0$$

$$\lambda^* = \arg \max_{\lambda \geq 0} \min_x \left[ f(x) + \lambda g(x) \right]$$

$x^*$  is the primal optimal and  $\lambda^*$  is the dual optimal.

Suppose, strong duality holds, then what are the **necessary** conditions that  $x^*$  and  $\lambda^*$  satisfy?

### Stationarity Condition and Complementary Slackness Condition

Let us focus on the Lagrangian function at  $x^*$  and  $\lambda^*$

$$L(x^*, \lambda^*) = f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*)$$

$\lambda^* g(x^*) \leq 0$ . Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} L(x^*, \lambda^*) &\leq f(x^*) \\ f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*) &\leq f(x^*) \quad \textbf{(A)} \end{aligned}$$

Let us now focus the dual formulation. Since  $\lambda^*$  is the dual optimal,

$$\max_{\lambda \geq 0} \min_x \left[ f(x) + \lambda g(x) \right] = \min_x \left[ f(x) + \lambda^* g(x) \right]$$

We are minimizing  $L(x, \lambda^*) = f(x) + \lambda^* g(x)$  with respect to  $x$ . Suppose  $x'$  is the argument that minimizes  $L(x, \lambda^*)$

$$x' = \arg \min_x f(x) + \lambda^* g(x)$$

then,  $L(x', \lambda^*) \leq L(x, \lambda^*)$  for all  $x$  in the domain of  $f$ . Therefore, it should be true for  $x^*$ ,

$$f(x') + \lambda^* g(x') \leq f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*) \quad \textbf{(B)}$$

From inequalities **(A)** and **(B)**, we get the following.

$$f(x') + \lambda^* g(x') \leq f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*) \leq f(x^*)$$

We know that

$$f(x') + \lambda^* g(x') = \min_x f(x) + \lambda^* g(x)$$

Therefore,

$$\min_x f(x) + \lambda^* g(x) \leq f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*) \leq f(x^*)$$

From strong duality, we know that

$$\min_x f(x) + \lambda^* g(x) = f(x^*)$$

Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned}\min_x f(x) + \lambda^* g(x) &= f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*) = f(x^*) \\ f(x') + \lambda^* g(x') &= f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*) = f(x^*)\end{aligned}$$

First, let us focus on  $f(x') + \lambda^* g(x') = f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*)$ . Recall

$$x' = \arg \min_x f(x) + \lambda^* g(x)$$

$x'$  is a solution to an unconstrained optimization problem. Therefore,  $\nabla f(x') + \lambda^* \nabla g(x') = 0$ .

$$\begin{aligned}f(x') + \lambda^* g(x') &= f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*) \\ \nabla f(x') + \lambda^* \nabla g(x') &= \nabla f(x^*) + \lambda^* \nabla g(x^*) \\ 0 &= \nabla f(x^*) + \lambda^* \nabla g(x^*)\end{aligned}$$

$\nabla f(x^*) + \lambda^* \nabla g(x^*) = 0$  is called the **stationarity condition**. The gradient of the lagrangian at  $x^*$  and  $\lambda^*$  should be equal to 0.

Let us focus on  $f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*) = f(x^*)$

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^*) + \lambda^* g(x^*) &= f(x^*) \\ \lambda^* g(x^*) &= 0\end{aligned}$$

This is called the **complementary slackness condition**. Either  $g(x^*) = 0$  or  $\lambda^* = 0$ .

## KKT Condition (Formal)

$$\begin{aligned}\min_x & f(x) \\ \text{s. t.} & \\ p_1(x) & \leq 0, \dots, p_n(x) \leq 0 \\ q_1(x) & = 0, \dots, q_m(x) = 0\end{aligned}$$



The following is the lagrangian function for the above formulation.

$$L(x, \alpha, \beta) = f(x) + \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i p_i(x) + \sum_{j=1}^m \beta_j q_j(x)$$

where,

$$\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_1 \\ \alpha_2 \\ \vdots \\ \alpha_n \end{pmatrix}, \beta = \begin{pmatrix} \beta_1 \\ \beta_2 \\ \vdots \\ \beta_m \end{pmatrix}$$

Let us define  $x^*$ ,  $\alpha^*$  and  $\beta^*$  as follows

$$x^* = \arg \min_x \left( \max_{\alpha \geq 0, \beta} L(x, \alpha, \beta) \right)$$

$$\alpha^*, \beta^* = \arg \max_{\alpha \geq 0, \beta} \left( \min_x L(x, \alpha, \beta) \right)$$

Suppose, strong duality holds true. Then, the following are **necessary** condition that  $x^*$ ,  $\alpha^*$  and  $\beta^*$  have to satisfy. They are called the **KKT** conditions.

#### (A) Stationarity Condition

$$\nabla f(x^*) + \sum_{i=1}^n (\alpha^*)_i \nabla p_i(x^*) + \sum_{j=1}^m (\beta^*)_j \nabla q_j(x^*) = 0$$

#### (B) Complementary Slackness Condition

$$\alpha_i^* p_i(x^*) = 0, \forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$$

Since  $q_j(x^*) = 0$ , is true  $\forall j \in \{1, \dots, m\}$ , the condition  $\beta_j q_j(x^*) = 0$  automatically holds true  $\forall \beta_j \in \mathbb{R}$ . Therefore, it does not impose any additional constraint and is not included as a KKT condition.

#### (C) Primal Feasibility

$$p_i(x^*) \leq 0, \forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$$

$$q_j(x^*) = 0, \forall j \in \{1, \dots, m\}$$

#### (D) Dual Feasibility

$$\alpha_i \geq 0, \forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$$

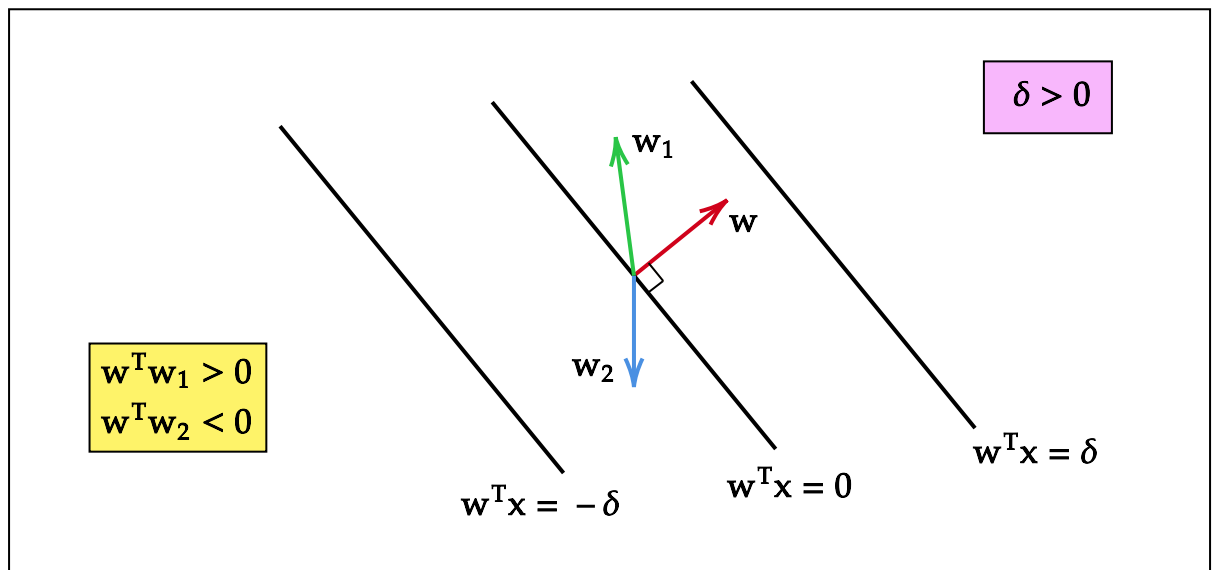
$\beta_j$  can be any real number,  $\forall j \in \{1, \dots, m\}$ .

## Sufficient Condition

Suppose, strong duality holds true. If  $x^*$ ,  $\alpha^*$  and  $\beta^*$  satisfy the **KKT** conditions,

- $x^*$  is the primal optimum
- $\alpha^*$  and  $\beta^*$  are the dual optimal

## 9. Dot Product



- The angle between  $w$  and  $w_1$  is less than  $90^\circ$ . Therefore,  $w^T w_1 > 0$ .
- The angle between  $w$  and  $w_2$  is greater than  $90^\circ$ . Therefore,  $w^T w_2 < 0$ .

## 10. Geometric Perspective of Stationarity Condition

For this section, let us assume that strong duality holds.

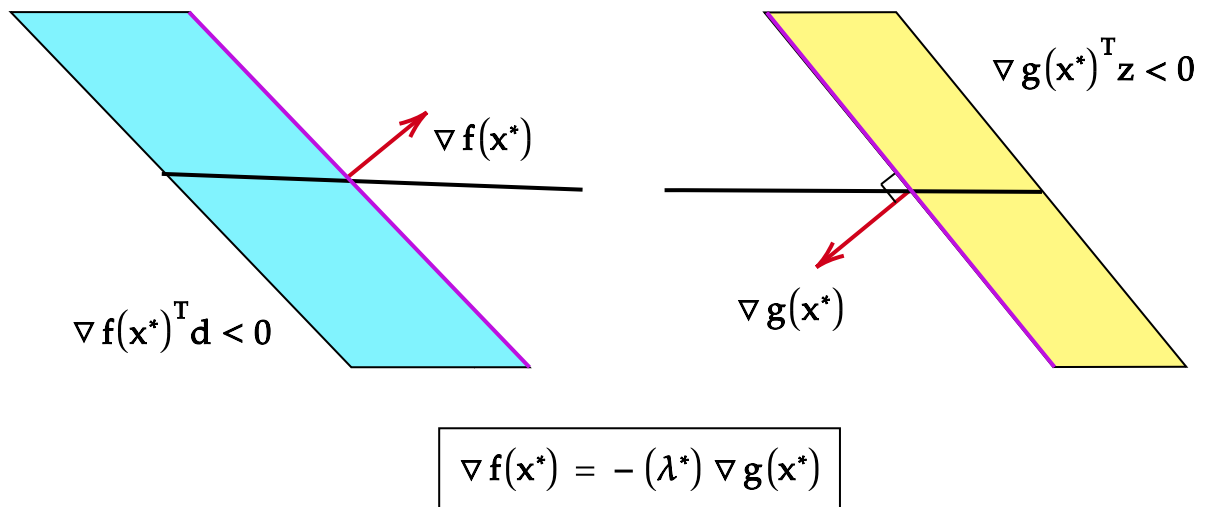
### Inequality Constraint

$$\begin{aligned} \min_x & f(x) \\ \text{s. t.} & \\ & g(x) \leq 0 \end{aligned}$$

Let  $x^*$  be the primal optimum and let  $\lambda^*$  be the dual optimum. By stationarity condition,

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla f(x^*) + \lambda^* \nabla g(x^*) &= 0 \\ \nabla f(x^*) &= -\lambda^* \nabla g(x^*) \end{aligned}$$

Since  $\lambda^* \geq 0$ , the gradient of  $f$  at  $x^*$  and the gradient of  $g$  at  $x^*$  are **anti-parallel** to each other.



From Taylor series,

$$f(x^* + d) \approx f(x^*) + \nabla f(x^*)^T (d)$$

$$f(x^* + d) - f(x^*) \approx \nabla f(x^*)^T (d)$$

and

$$g(x^* + z) \approx g(x^*) + \nabla g(x^*)^T (z)$$

$$g(x^* + z) - g(x^*) \approx \nabla g(x^*)^T (z)$$

The blue region is denoted by

$$\left\{ d \mid \nabla f(x^*)^T d \leq 0 \right\}$$

Therefore,

$$f(x^* + d) - f(x^*) \leq 0$$

Yellow region is denoted by

$$\left\{ z \mid \nabla g(x^*)^T z \leq 0 \right\}$$

Therefore,

$$g(x^* + z) - g(x^*) \leq 0$$

- $d$  is a **descent** direction of  $f$  at  $x^*$
- $z$  is a **descent** direction of  $g$  at  $x^*$ .

**Descent Direction** : For a function  $h(x)$ ,  $d$  is a descent direction at  $x^*$ , if for some sufficiently small  $\beta > 0$ ,  $h(x + \beta d) < h(x)$ .

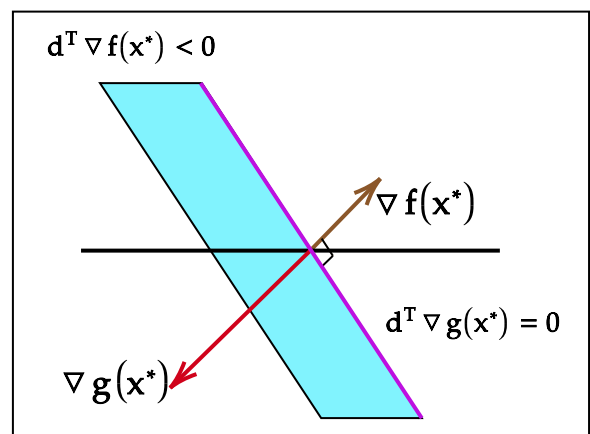
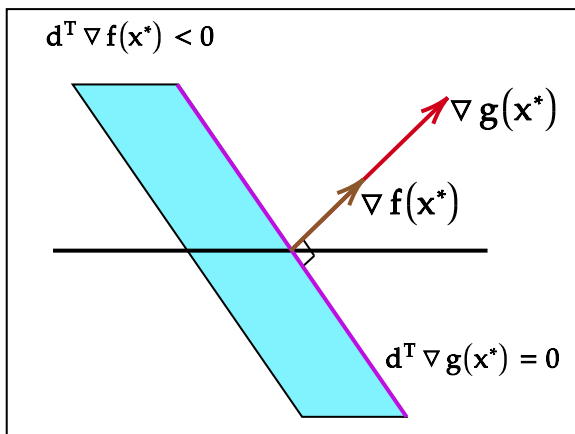
## Equality Constraint

$$\begin{aligned} \min_x \quad & f(x) \\ \text{s. t.} \quad & g(x) = 0 \end{aligned}$$

Let  $x^*$  be the primal optimum and let  $\lambda^*$  be the dual optimum. By stationarity condition,

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla f(x^*) + \lambda^* \nabla g(x^*) &= 0 \\ \nabla f(x^*) &= -\lambda^* \nabla g(x^*) \end{aligned}$$

For equality constraint,  $\lambda$  can be any real number. Therefore,  $\nabla f(x^*)$  and  $\nabla g(x^*)$  are scalar multiples of each other.



The pink line represents all the directions  $d$  such that :

$$d^T \nabla g(x^*) = 0$$

Along these directions, the value of the function  $g(x)$  remains equal to  $g(x^*)$ . Since  $x^*$  is the primal optimal, it satisfies  $g(x^*) = 0$ . As a result, the value of the function  $g(x)$  along the pink line is also 0. For sufficiently small steps along the pink line, the constraint  $g(x) = 0$  remains satisfied.

The blue region corresponds to  $\left\{ d \mid d^T \nabla f(x^*) \leq 0 \right\}$ . The blue region are the descent directions of  $f$  at  $x^*$ .

Notice that the blue region and the pink line do not intersect. If they were to intersect, then there would exist a direction along the pink line that is also a descent direction for  $f$  at  $x^*$ . In that case, starting from  $x^*$  we could take a sufficiently small step along the pink direction and reduce the value of the objective function  $f(x)$  while still satisfying the constraint  $g(x) = 0$ . This would imply that  $x^*$  is not an optimal solution.

---

## 11. Method Of Lagrange Multipliers (Example)

$$\min_{x_1, x_2} [f(x_1, x_2) = x_1^2 + 2x_2 + 4x_2^2]$$

$$s. t \ g(x_1, x_2) = 0$$

$$g(x_1, x_2) = x_1^2 + x_2^2 - 1$$

Find gradient

$$\nabla f(x_1, x_2) = (2x_1, 2 + 8x_2)$$

$$\nabla g(x_1, x_2) = (2x_1, 2x_2)$$

We have an equality constraint.

By stationarity condition, ( $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$ )

$$\nabla f(x_1, x_2) = -\lambda \nabla g(x_1, x_2)$$

$$(2x_1, 2 + 8x_2) = -\lambda(2x_1, 2x_2)$$

We get the following equations

$$2x_1 = -\lambda(2x_1) \quad (4)$$

$$2 + 8x_2 = -\lambda(2x_2) \quad (5)$$

For (1) to be satisfied, either  $\lambda = -1$  or  $x_1 = 0$ .

**CASE 1 :  $-\lambda = 1$**

Substitute  $-\lambda = 1$  in (2)

$$2 + 8x_2 = 2x_2$$

$$6x_2 = -2$$

$$x_2 = (-1/3)$$

By primal feasibility,  $g(x_1, x_2) = 0$ . Substitute  $x_2 = (-1/3)$  in  $g(x_1, x_2) = 0$

$$x_1^2 + (-1/3)^2 - 1 = 0$$

$$x_1^2 = (8/9)$$

$$x_1 = \pm\sqrt{8/9}$$

**CASE 2 :  $x_1 = 0$**

Substitute  $x_1 = 0$  in  $g(x_1, x_2) = 0$

$$0^2 + x_2^2 - 1 = 0$$

$$x_2 = \pm 1$$

Possible solutions

$$\left\{ \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{8/9} \\ -1/3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} -\sqrt{8/9} \\ -1/3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} \right\}$$

Find the value of  $f$  at these points.

$$f\left(\begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{8/9} \\ -1/3 \end{pmatrix}\right) = \frac{2}{3}$$

$$f\left(\begin{pmatrix} -\sqrt{8/9} \\ -1/3 \end{pmatrix}\right) = \frac{2}{3}$$

$$f\left(\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}\right) = 6$$

$$f\left(\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}\right) = 2$$

Therefore,  $\begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{8/9} \\ -1/3 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\begin{pmatrix} -\sqrt{8/9} \\ -1/3 \end{pmatrix}$  are the optimal solutions.

---

## 12. Projected Gradient Descent

It might be difficult to solve constrained optimization analytically, using the method of Lagrange multipliers. Here is an iterative algorithm.

**GOAL**

$$\min_x [f(x)]$$

$$s. t \ g(x) \leq 0$$

Let  $\eta_t > 0$

**STEP 1** : Initialize  $x_0$

**STEP 2** : For  $t$  in  $\{0, 1, 2, \dots, T\}$

$$x_{t+1} = \Pi \left( x_t - \eta \nabla f(x_t) \right)$$

**STEP 3** : End

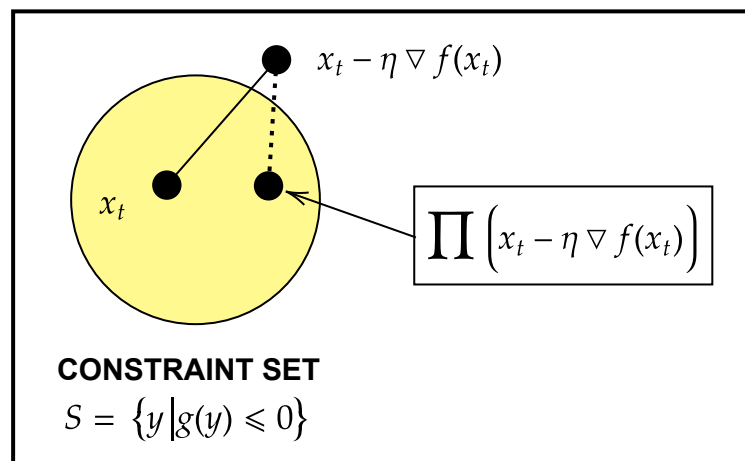
- **Gradient Step** :  $x_t - \eta \nabla f(x_t)$
- **Projection Step** :  $\Pi \left( x_t - \eta \nabla f(x_t) \right)$

Here,

$$\Pi(x) = \arg \min_{y \in S} \|x - y\|^2$$

where

$$S = \{y \mid g(y) \leq 0\}$$



In the above picture, the projection step finds the point set  $S$ , that is closest to  $x_t - \eta \nabla f(x_t)$ .

If the constraint set is **convex**, then projected gradient descent converges to an optimal solution, under suitable conditions on the objective function.

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## 13. Stochastic Gradient Descent

Let us revisit linear regression (week – 4). Consider the following dataset.

$$D = \{(x_1, y_1), \dots, (x_n, y_n)\}$$

where,  $x_i \in \mathbb{R}^d$ , and  $y \in \mathbb{R}$ ,  $\forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$

- $x_i \rightarrow$  data point
- $y_i \rightarrow$  corresponding label

Consider matrix  $X$  and  $Y$

$$X = \begin{bmatrix} - & x_1 & - & 1 \\ - & x_2 & - & 1 \\ & \vdots & & \vdots \\ - & x_n & - & 1 \end{bmatrix}_{n \times (d+1)}, \quad Y = \begin{bmatrix} y_1 \\ y_2 \\ \vdots \\ y_n \end{bmatrix}_{n \times 1}$$

Every row of  $X$  is a data point. All the entries in the last column of  $X$  are 1. The goal is to find  $\hat{\mathbf{w}} \in \mathbb{R}^{d+1}$  such that

$$\hat{\mathbf{w}} = \arg \min_{\mathbf{w}} \left\| X\mathbf{w} - Y \right\|^2$$

Let  $f(\mathbf{w}) = \left\| X\mathbf{w} - Y \right\|^2$ .  $f(\mathbf{w})$  can also be written as follows :

$$f(\mathbf{w}) = \sum_{i=1}^n \left( \mathbf{w}^T x_i - y_i \right)^2$$

Let us focus on  $h_i(\mathbf{w}) = \left( \mathbf{w}^T x_i - y_i \right)^2$ .  $h_i(\mathbf{w})$  can be written as follows :

$$h_i(\mathbf{w}) = p(q_i(\mathbf{w}))$$

where,

$$p(x) = x^2$$

$$q_i(\mathbf{w}) = \mathbf{w}^T x_i - y_i$$

$q_i(\mathbf{w})$  is a linear function, and  $p(x)$  is a convex function. The composition of a convex function and a linear function is convex. Therefore,  $h_i(\mathbf{w})$  is convex.

$f(\mathbf{w})$  is a sum of convex functions, and is therefore, convex.

- Every local minima of  $f$  is also a global minima
- $\hat{\mathbf{w}}$  is a global minima if and only if  $\nabla f(\hat{\mathbf{w}}) = 0$

$$\hat{\mathbf{w}} = \arg \min_{\mathbf{w}} \sum_{i=1}^n \left( \mathbf{w}^T x_i - y_i \right)^2$$

The gradient of  $f$  is given as follows :

$$\nabla f(\mathbf{w}) = X^T X \mathbf{w} - X^T Y$$



Setting  $\nabla f(\mathbf{w}) = 0$

$$\begin{aligned} X^T X \mathbf{w} - X^T Y &= 0 \\ \mathbf{w} &= (X^T X)^+ X^T Y \end{aligned}$$

$+$  symbol denotes the **pseudoinverse**. If  $X^T X$  has an inverse, then

$$\mathbf{w} = (X^T X)^{-1} X^T Y$$

The time complexity of computing  $(X^T X)^{-1}$  is  $O(d^3)$ . If  $d$  is large, then computing  $(X^T X)^{-1}$  would be computationally costly.

For the objective function, every local minimum is also a global minimum. We know that the gradient descent algorithm converges to a local minimum. If  $d$  is large, instead of computing  $(X^T X)^{-1}$ , we can use **gradient descent** find  $\hat{\mathbf{w}}$ . Here is the algorithm. Let  $\eta_t = \frac{1}{t+1}$

- Initialize  $\mathbf{w}_0$
- for  $t \in \{0, \dots, T\}$ 
  - $\mathbf{w}_{t+1} = \mathbf{w}_t - \eta_t (X^T X \mathbf{w}_t - X^T Y)$
- End

To compute the gradient, we need not find the inverse of  $X^T X$ .

$X^T$  is a  $d \times n$  matrix and  $X$  is an  $n \times d$  matrix. Suppose,  $n$ , which corresponds to the number of data points is large, then computing  $X^T X$  would be costly. In such cases, we can make use of an algorithm called the **stochastic gradient descent**. Here is the algorithm. Let  $\eta_t = \frac{1}{t+1}$

- Initialize  $\mathbf{w}_0$
- For  $t \in \{0, \dots, T-1\}$ 
  - Sample  $k$  data points (where  $k \ll n$ ), and their corresponding labels from  $\{(x_1, y_1), \dots, (x_n, y_n)\}$ .
  - Let the sampled data points be  $p_1, \dots, p_k$  and let their corresponding labels be  $q_1, \dots, q_k$
  - Consider the matrices  $P$  and  $Q$

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} - & p_1 & - & 1 \\ - & p_2 & - & 1 \\ & \vdots & & \vdots \\ - & p_k & - & 1 \end{bmatrix}_{k \times (d+1)}, \quad Q = \begin{bmatrix} q_1 \\ q_2 \\ \vdots \\ q_k \end{bmatrix}_{k \times 1}$$

◦ Update

as

follows

$$\mathbf{w}_{t+1} = \mathbf{w}_t - \eta_t (P^T P \mathbf{w}_t - P^T Q)$$

• End

It can be shown that the average of

$$\frac{1}{T+1} \left( \sum_{t=0}^T \mathbf{w}_t \right) \rightarrow \hat{\mathbf{w}}$$


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